

SECTION	DESCRIPTION
1	User commands available to everyone.
2	System calls and functions provided by the kernel.
3	Subroutines, i.e., library functions.
4	Devices or the special files in the /dev directory.
5	File format descriptions, e.g. /etc/passwd.
6	Games that are self-explanatory.
7	Misc. information, e.g. macro packages, conventions.
8	System administration tools accessible only to root users.
9	Another place for kernel routine documentation.
n (Deprecated)	New documentation that may be moved to a more appropriate section. (Deprecated)
o (Deprecated)	Old documentation that may be kept for a grace period. (Deprecated)
l (Deprecated)	Local documentation referring to this particular system. (Deprecated)

Note: As per the Filesystem Hierarchy Standard, the use of n, l, and o sections are deprecated, so avoid them.

Man page source file name is the original name of the function, command or file name, followed by a single dot and a character for that specific section. For instance, for a 'passwd' documentation file, source file is named as 'passwd.5'. Similarly, library subroutines with the same name may also be there, so this sectioning is done in a way to solve these ambiguities.

Linux Man Page Sections

In Linux, Man pages conventions are in the following order:

Name, Synopsis, Configuration, Description, Options, Exit Status, Return Value, Errors, Environment, Files, Versions, Conforming to, Notes, Bugs, Example, See also

Some sections are limited to their specific usage, for instance:

- The configuration section is found for documenting devices only.
- Both Options and Exit Status are there when commands are in discussion. (Ordinary and root users)
- Errors, Return Values, and Versions are for library functions, and system calls only.